

KEEP THIS ONE; IT'S BUILT TO LIVE ON YOUR DESK

# AI Foundations & Safety: The One Hard Rule

## THE ONE HARD RULE

**Never put student personally identifiable information into a public AI tool. Not a name. Not a detail. Ever.**

## What an AI chatbot actually is

ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, and Copilot don't look up facts; they **predict likely next words**, learned from enormous amounts of text. That's why the writing is fluent, and why it can be smoothly, confidently wrong. In one peer-reviewed test, nearly 20% of the citations an AI produced were entirely invented, and they looked perfect.

### The intern is great at

- First drafts: newsletters, routine emails
- Leveling a text you already like (3 reading levels)
- Rubrics, word banks, question sets from your notes
- Reformatting: quiz ⇄ table ⇄ station cards

### The intern cannot

- Know your students, or care about them
- Verify its own facts (that's you)
- Be trusted unreviewed with parents or kids
- Make the judgment calls; those stay yours

**The posture in five words: AI drafts, the teacher decides.** Nothing AI-made reaches a student or family without a human reading it first.

## What counts as student PII

### The obvious

- Names, initials, photos
- Student ID numbers
- Grades & test scores tied to a student
- Addresses, family details

### The sneaky

- Initials + context ("J.M., 3rd period, anxiety dx")
- One-of-a-kind details (the only new student from Ukraine)
- IEP / 504 contents & accommodations
- Discipline or health specifics

**The test:** could anyone who knows our school figure out who this is? If yes, it doesn't go in the box. (Deleting the chat later doesn't undo what the company received.)

## De-identify like a pro: the 3 moves (≈10 seconds)

| Move                                 | Instead of...                                 | Write...                                                  |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 • Strip identity                   | "Jayden Miller's mom"                         | "a parent"                                                |
| 2 • Generalize                       | "Sofia R., 7th grade, new arrival"            | "a 7th grader new to the school"                          |
| 3 • Describe the need, not the child | "her reading IEP with 2nd-grade fluency goal" | "rewrite at a 2nd-grade reading level, shorter sentences" |

## Safe swap: worked example

**Unsafe**

"Write an email to Jayden Miller's mom about his three missing assignments and his outburst Tuesday."

**Safe**

"Write a warm, professional email to a parent about a middle schooler with several missing assignments and a recent difficult day in class. Firm but supportive; end by inviting a conversation." → add the name after it's back in your own email account.

**Public tool vs. approved tool:** everything you signed up for yourself is a public tool. If our district formally adopts a vetted AI platform with a student-data agreement, you'll be told explicitly what changes. Until then, the rule applies everywhere.

## Starter prompts: safe by design, tested in classrooms

### Families & communication

- "Write a warm, professional newsletter blurb for families about [event], under 120 words."
- "Make this note to families friendlier without losing the deadline: [paste your draft]."

### Planning & differentiation

- "Rewrite this passage at three reading levels (2nd, 4th, and 6th grade). Keep the key ideas: [paste]."
- "Give me five different warm-up questions on [topic], from recall to open-ended."

### Assessment

- "Create a five-question review quiz on [topic], mixed difficulty, with an answer key."
- "Turn these notes into a 4-level rubric with student-friendly language: [paste notes]."

**The lab habit, forever: make it safe, then make it work.** Say the prompt in your head, strip it with the 3 moves, type only the safe version. Names go back in inside your own email or doc, never in the tool. If a prompt only works with a child's identity in it, it isn't ready.

## Our three commitments

1. **No student PII in public AI tools.** Ever.
2. **A human reviews everything** AI-drafted before it reaches a student or family.
3. **We share what works.** A prompt that saved you an hour belongs in the staff room.

## My notes

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